• Major Institutions, Treaties, Commissions, Acts, Pacts

16. The Gandhi-Irwin Pact included which of the following?

1. Invitation to Congress to participate in the Round Table Conference
2. Withdrawal of Ordinances promulgated in connection with the Civil Disobedience Movement
3. Acceptance of Gandhiji's suggestion for enquiry into police excesses
4. Release of only those prisoners who were not charged with violence

Select the correct answer using the code given below:

(a) 1 only (b) 1, 2 and 4 only
(c) 3 only (d) 2, 3 and 4 only

Ans. (*) : On 5th March, 1931, the Gandhi-Irwin Pact was signed by Gandhiji on behalf of Congress and by Lord Irwin on behalf of the Government. The pact placed the Congress on an equal footing with the government. The terms of the agreement included immediate release of all political prisoners not convicted in violence, remission of all fines not yet collected, return of all lands not yet sold to third parties; lenient treatment to those government servants who has resigned; right to make salt in coastal villages for personal consumption; right to peaceful and non aggressive picketing; withdrawal of emergency ordinances. The viceroy, however turned down two of Gandhi's demands,

- public inquiry into police excesses
- commutation of Bhagat Singh and his comrades' death sentence to life sentence.

Gandhi agreed to on behalf of Congress,

- To suspend the civil disobedience movement.
- To participate in Second Round table conference.

• Miscellaneous

17. Which of the following statements correctly explains the impact of Industrial Revolution on India during the first half of the nineteenth century?

(a) Indian handicrafts were ruined
(b) Machines were introduced in the Indian textile industry in large numbers
(c) Railway lines were laid in many parts of the country
(d) Heavy duties were imposed on the imports of British manufactures

Ans. (a) : During the late 18th century and early 19th century, there was a big change in the technical, social, economic and cultural status of Western countries, which is known as Industrial Revolution. The beginning of the industrial revolution began with the mechanization of the textile industry. From the point of view of employment, the capital invested and the value of goods produced, the textile industry itself was the most important industry in the industrial revolution. The textile industry itself first used modern methods of production; due to this technological development, the market in India was flooded with inexpensive machine-made goods, which not only adversely affected the Indian handicrafts industry but they reached the verge of closure.

18. With reference to the book "Desher Katha" written by Sakharam Ganesh Deuskar during the freedom struggle, consider the following statements:

1. It warned against the Colonial State's hypnotic conquest of the mind
2. It inspired the performance of swadeshi street plays and folk songs.
3. The use of 'desh' by Deuskar was in the specific context of the region of Bengal.

Which of the statements given above are correct?

(a) 1 and 2 only (b) 2 and 3 only
(c) 1 and 3 only (d) 1, 2 and 3

Ans. (a) : Sakharam Ganesh Deuskar made the country's independence the goal of his life and kept contact with the revolutionary movement and contributed to the public awakening by composing literature in Bengali and Hindi. In 1904, he wrote a book called "Desher Katha" to address the indigenous idea of Ranade and Dada Bhai Naoroji. In this book, the British state was warmed for their compelling victory through indigenous dramas and folk songs. For him, this book "Desherkatha" played an important role in the Indian freedom struggle. Arvind Ghosh wrote that the first use of the word "Swarajaya" was done by Sakharam Ganesh Deuskar in "Desher Katha". This book was translated into the "Desh ki Baat" by Babu Rao Vishnu Paradkar.

19. The Vital-Vidhvansak, the first monthly journal to have the untouchable people as its target audience was published by–

(a) Gopal Baba Walangkar
(b) Jyotiba Phule
(c) Mohandas Karamchand Gandhi
(d) Bhimrao Ramji Ambedkar

Ans. (a) : Gopal Baba Walangkar was a social reformer who did many things for the improvement of untouchables. He worked to release the people from socio-economic exploitation. In 1888, he published a monthly gournal called Vital-Vidhvansak with the aim of making the untouchable society aware.

INDIAN GEOGRAPHY

• Physical Structure/Drainage System/ Human Geography

20. Siachen Glacier is situated to the

(a) East of Aksai Chin (b) East of Leh
(c) North of Gilgit (d) North of Nubra Valley

Ans. (d) : Siachen Glacier is the largest glacier in the Himalayas. The Siachen Glacier is the world's second largest glacier outside the polar region. The length of this glacier is about 72 km. This glacier lies to the north of the Nubra valley.

• Monsoon, Forest, Soil, Irrigation Projects, Agriculture

21. "The crop is subtropical in nature. A hard frost is injurious to it. It requires at least 210 frost-free days and 50 to 100 centimeters of rainfall for its growth. A light well-drained soil capable of retaining moisture is ideally suited for the cultivation of the crop." Which one of the following is that crop?

(a) Cotton (b) Jute
(c) Sugarcane (d) Tea

Ans. (a) : Cotton is a cash crop. It is a member of Malvaceae group. Cotton crop is of subtropical nature, Harsh frost is harmful to this crop. It requires at least 210 frost free-days and 50 to 100 cm of rainfall for its growth. A light well-drained soil capable of retaining moisture (black soil) is suitable for the cultivation of the crop. For cotton crops, the temperature should not exceed 30ºC. In the commercial world, cotton is called white gold.

• Minerals, Power Resources and Industry & Trade

22. Consider the following minerals:

1. Bentonite 2. Chromite
3. Kyanite 4. Sillimanite

In India, which of the above is/are officially designated as major minerals?

(a) 1 and 2 only (b) 4 only
(c) 1 and 3 only (d) 2,3 and 4 only

Ans. (d) : Major minerals are those specified in the first schedule appended in the MMDR Act. There is no official definition for major minerals in the MMD Act. Hence, whatever is not declared as a "minor mineral" may be treated as the major mineral. The Central Government has the power to notify 'minor mineral' under Section 3(e) of the MMDR Act, 1957. On the other hand, as per Section 15 of the MMDR Act, 1957 State Government, have complete powers for making rules for grant of concessions in respect of extraction of minor minerals and levy and collection of royalty on minor minerals. Thus, minor minerals are building stones, gravel, ordinary clay, ordinary sand other than sand used for prescribed purposes etc. Therefore, chromite, kyanite and sillimanite are major minerals, whereas Bentonite is a minor mineral.

23. With reference to chemical fertilizers in India, consider the following statements:

1. At present, the retail price of chemical fertilizers is market-driven and not administered by the Government.
2. Ammonia, which is an input of urea, is produced from natural gas.
3. Sulphur, which is a raw material for phosphoric acid fertilizer, is a by-product of oil refineries.

Which of the statement given above is/are correct?

(a) 1 only (b) 2 and 3 only
(c) 2 only (d) 1, 2 and 3

Ans. (b) : The Government of India subsidizes fertilizers to ensure that fertilizers are easily available to farmers and the country remains self-sufficient in agriculture. Some has been achieved largely by controlling the price of fertilizer and the amount of production. The urea is being provided to the farmers at a statutorily notified maximum retail price (MRP). Under the NBS policy, the government announces a fixed rate of subsidy (in Rs. per kg basis), on each nutrient of subsidized fertilizers, namely Nitrogen (N), Phosphate (P), Potash (K) and Sulphur (S) on an annual basis. Hence statement 1 is not correct. Synthetic ammonia (NH_3) refers to ammonia that has been synthesized for Natural gas. Natural gas molecules are reduced to carbon and hydrogen. The hydrogen is then purified and reacted with nitrogen to produce ammonia. Approximately 75 percent of the ammonia produced is used as fertilizer, either directly as ammonia or indirectly after synthesis as urea, ammonium nitrate and mono-ammonium or diammonium phosphates. Hence statement 2 is correct.

Sulphur is a major by-product of oil refining and gas processing. Most crude oil grades contain some sulphur, most of which must be removed during the refining process to meet strict sulphur content limits in refined products. Most of the sulphur produced by refineries is sold into the petrochemicals market where it is used to make sulfuric acid. Commercial phosphoric acid is produced by applying an excess of sulphuric acid to ground rock phosphate. Hence statement 3 is correct.